

ENGLISH 101: COMPOSITION



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Licensing

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

1: Weeding "You" Out

Students will read two text samples about disability access--one heavily addressing "you" in second-person perspective and the other in the third-person perspective--to familiarize why formal papers should avoid second-person perspective. Students will then receive tips to practice eradicating second-person pronouns from their writing.

[1.1: Weeding "You" Out Introduction and Reading](#)

[1.2: Weeding "You" Out- Activity](#)

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1.1: Weeding "You" Out Introduction and Reading

Summary:

The point of this lesson is to observe and practice an aspect of formal, academic writing—to write in the third person so that the audience can be slightly removed from the reading and not feel judged.

Introduction:

The second-person perspective is who the first person is having a conversation with. I will address *you*. *You* are reading this. *You* are asking, ‘Why am I reading this?’ It is very direct, of course. Often when we speak one-on-one with friends and relatives, we use a lot of second-person pronouns because that is our audience. If our audience does not understand something--the perspective, the topic, the tone, or the subject--they can ask in person.

The third person is used for someone removed from the first or second person—someone not ‘us’ or ‘me’ or ‘you’ but ‘them,’ ‘they,’ ‘he,’ ‘she,’ or ‘that chair,’ ‘the students,’ ‘her friend,’ ‘Angel,’ ‘Dr. Salgado,’ ‘my cats,’ and ‘Sal.’ For academic text, strive for third-person usage. Readers are not as familiar with their writers as they are with their friends and family. They certainly can’t ask questions about perspective and expect immediate answers.

As you read the first text, note the ways it makes you feel. While reading the second text, note how the second person (“you”, “your”, etc.) is changed to the more impersonal third person use--not just pronouns like “it”, “they”, and “them”, but also nouns such as “workers”, “students”, “readers”, “citizens”, “drivers”, etc. Note how the sentences are changed to make this distinction as well. Note how it, also, makes you feel.

First Text:

This city is not made for people with mobility impairments, which include physically disabled, elderly, and blind people. You would know that if you tried to step in their shoes or wheels or at least talked to them. The list of ways in which your city does not meet the minimum requirements for disabled people to get around easily is long, but you are responsible for knowing what they are. For starters, you don’t have elevators at many of your train stations, and existing ones often break down. Secondly, have you tried to walk around town in a wheelchair or without vision? If you did, you would notice that many of the sidewalks are inaccessible. You can’t even walk around many sidewalks in some communities, let alone drive wheels over them because the pavement is in such bad shape. Many of the ADA-compliant ramps that allow wheelchairs are blocked during the winter by shoveled snow or ice and in the rest of the seasons by cars, or they are in disrepair. If you’re blind, you’ll also have the additional problem of not being sure when to cross the street as most traffic lights in the city lack sufficient audible supports. In short, you are not doing enough to make the city safe for disabled people.

Second Text:

This city is not made for people with mobility impairments, which include physically disabled, elderly, and blind people. Many are not aware of this due to a lack of contact with the disabled and elderly communities. Although the list of ways in which City Hall does not meet the minimum requirements for disabled people to get around easily is long, citizens should be aware of these lacks as residents and taxpayers. For starters, many train stations lack elevators, and existing ones often break down. Secondly, many sidewalks are inaccessible. Because the pavement is in such bad shape, residents who are blind, wheelchair-bound, and have other walking difficulties cannot walk on several sidewalks in some communities, let alone drive their wheels over them. Many of the ADA-compliant ramps that allow wheelchairs are blocked during the winter by shoveled snow or ice and in the rest of the seasons by other cars, or they are in disrepair. Blind pedestrians also have the additional problem of not being sure when to cross the street as most traffic lights in the city lack sufficient audible supports. In short, City Hall is not doing enough to make the city safe for disabled people.

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1.2: Weeding "You" Out- Activity

Open-ended question for readers:

- How did reading the first text make you feel?
- How did that first text make you approach the subject of disability mobility and access?
- What was evoked for you?
- What other effects did changing the pronouns to “you” and “your” have on you as a reader?
- Did you feel you could read it with some objectivity or did reading it make you feel charged in some way that took you out of the reading?
- How does that contrast with the second text?

As readers, we need some space between ourselves and the topic. Even though the second-person is perfectly fine in informal conversations (where we interact most with words), in the written word, it's a bit wonkier. This is partially because we do not have nonverbal cues, we are generally familiar with the person we are speaking with, and we have some back and forth with our interlocutor. Those elements are largely missing in the written word, and more so in formal and academic settings. Those differences often leave us bewildered and even feeling targeted when the speech becomes second-person. The first text feels accusatory, in fact.

Think of the difference between the next two sentences:

- “You should stop doing drugs because they’re bad for you.”
- “It is harmful for the human body to abuse drugs.”

In the first, we would likely get defensive, and rightly so. It is accusatory. Whether or not the reader partakes in drug use, she/he/they is likely to tell the writer to bug off and mind their own business. The second sentence allows us as readers to evaluate or at least accept the sentence objectively.

We also want to have a consistent perspective. Is the author talking to me? Is the author talking at me? Am I the subject or a witness?

Another reason to omit the second person is that it is too vague and confusing. Is the subject a specific person, a group of people, or a generalized group of people? In any case, the subject of the sentence should be as specific as possible. In the example above, making the subject ‘drug users’ rather than the reader themselves is much more precise and accurate. However, it would be even better to address the issue of drug abuse itself rather than some vague group of people stigmatized by society.

In the earlier texts, putting the responsibility for the city's sidewalks, ramps, and train stations on City Hall rather than some “you” in the audience is also precise. Readers can then decide if and how they want to pressure their local government rather than feel finger-wagged at.

Tips:

A few ways to break the “you” habit include the following:

- Use more precise nouns instead
 - Consider who should be addressed.
 - For instance, instead of “You should obey traffic laws,” consider “Drivers should...” or “Motorists should...” or “Police officers should...”
- Replace with alternating singular third-person pronouns (they, she, he).
- Use indefinite pronouns (everyone, someone, anything, one) instead.
 - Rather than “When you walk your dog,” “When one walks their dog...”
- Cut the “you” out altogether.
 - “Life sometimes feels like a roller coaster due to changes in your routines or your relationships,” can easily be switched to, “Life sometimes feels like a roller coaster due to changes in routines or relationships.”
- Reword the sentence.
 - This is the best option; it allows the writer to refocus the subject, often by changing the literal subject of the sentence.
 - Rearrange parts of the sentence.

- Instead of, “You can understand characters better by their actions,” try, “Characters are best understood through their actions,” or “Characters' actions define them.”
- “You wouldn't believe the troubles I had,” becomes, “The troubles I had are unbelievable.”
- Avoid giving commands (where “you” is the implied subject).

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1.3: Weeding "You" Out- Assignment

Try these tips in the following sentences. Rewrite so that the utterance is in the third person.

1. When bills arrive, you wonder how you are going to pay for them.
2. The dialogue helps us to understand the plot.
3. Are you wondering what kind of job you will seek after college?
4. You should really fix these potholes.
5. If you want to write well, you must get rid of “you” in formal papers!
6. In this paper, I will tell you why I think that gentrification does not address but rather provokes the problems it supposedly solves.
7. You should not allow smoking in apartment buildings, either.
8. You should not allow a smoker near your newborn child.
9. As you know, college isn't easy.
10. After reading this, you should agree with me that American foreign policy is a threat to world peace.
11. You might consider a particularly odious departure to be lumped in amongst this group.

Now, take these practices into your work. Look at your latest writing draft—maybe even go back to earlier work—and do a word search for ‘you’. Find alternatives for each example until you have eliminated all the second-person mentions from your writing.

Now you are an expert in eliminating second-person pronouns!

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

2: "Why I Am Against the War in Vietnam"- Writing for an Audience

Students will read from a speech given by Martin Luther King to help identify who his audience is and the importance of identifying audiences. Students will then direct a similar speech or essay to their peers.

[2.1: Writing for an Audience- Introduction and MLK Speech](#)

[2.2: Writing for an Audience Classroom Activity](#)

[2.3: Writing for an Audience Assignment](#)

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2.1: Writing for an Audience- Introduction and MLK Speech

Introduction and instructions for students:

Read the following text with the knowledge that the Reverend Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr. may be best known for his nonviolent approach to civil rights for Black people in America—especially in the South—and for his fiery and eloquent oratory skills. However, after the passing of the Civil Rights Act, he was increasingly discomforted by the political mechanism of United States politics as a whole. One of the main *evils* (his terminology) he spoke and demonstrated against in this era was the growing discontent, injustices, and inequalities that Black people in the North faced. About his time spent in Chicago working against segregated and inferior housing for Black people, King said he never faced such open racism even in the Deep South. American militarism was another great evil he campaigned against, which he noted also has roots in racism. The following speech focused on the war against Vietnam.

While reading the following speech given at a church, find evidence to identify who King's audience is. Be as specific as possible. Keep in mind that he may have a few audiences in mind; not just the people he was speaking to that day, but others who may hear the speech or would read transcripts of it later.

What evidence shows this? Find signifiers from direct and indirect references to his audience. These could include cultural practices, accepted ideology, use of terminology, people he talks about, etc. Underline or highlight them (in a separate doc) or take notes. Begin thinking about how recognizing and acknowledging his audience translates to the effectiveness of his speech.

Text:

"Why I Am Opposed to the War in Vietnam" by Martin Luther King, Jr. was delivered to the Riverside Church in New York City.

The sermon which I am preaching this morning in a sense is not the usual kind of sermon, but it is a sermon and an important subject, nevertheless, because the issue that I will be discussing today is one of the most controversial issues confronting our nation. I'm using as a subject from which to preach, "Why I Am Opposed to the War in Vietnam."

Now, let me make it clear in the beginning, that I see this war as an unjust, evil, and futile war. I preach to you today on the war in Vietnam because my conscience leaves me with no other choice. The time has come for America to hear the truth about this tragic war. In international conflicts, the truth is hard to come by because most nations are deceived about themselves. Rationalizations and the incessant search for scapegoats are the psychological cataracts that blind us to our sins. But the day has passed for superficial patriotism. He who lives with untruth

lives in spiritual slavery. Freedom is still the bonus we receive for knowing the truth. "Ye shall know the truth," says Jesus, "and the truth shall set you free." Now, I've chosen to preach about the war in Vietnam because I agree with Dante, that the hottest places in hell are reserved for those who in a period of moral crisis maintain their neutrality. There comes a time when silence becomes betrayal.

The truth of these words is beyond doubt, but the mission to which they call us is a most difficult one. Even when pressed by the demands of inner truth, men do not easily assume the task of opposing their government's policy, especially in time of war. Nor does the human spirit move without great difficulty against all the apathy of conformist thought within one's own bosom and in the surrounding world. Moreover, when the issues at hand seem as perplexing, as they often do in the case of this dreadful conflict, we're always on the verge of being mesmerized by uncertainty. But we must move on. Some of us who have already begun to break the silence of the night have found that the calling to speak is often a vocation of agony. But we must speak. We must speak with all the humility that is appropriate to our limited vision, but we must speak. And we must rejoice as well, for in all our history there has never been such a monumental dissent during a war, by the American people.

Polls reveal that almost fifteen million Americans explicitly oppose the war in Vietnam. Additional millions cannot bring themselves around to support it. And even those millions who do support the war [are] half-hearted, confused, and doubt-ridden. This reveals that millions have chosen to move beyond the prophesying of smooth patriotism, to the high grounds of firm dissent, based upon the mandates of conscience and the reading of history. Now, of course, one of the difficulties in speaking out today grows the fact that there are those who are seeking to equate dissent with disloyalty. It's a dark day in our nation when high-level authorities will seek to use every method to silence dissent. But something is happening, and people are not going to be silenced. The truth must be told, and I say that those who are seeking to make it appear that anyone who opposes the war in Vietnam is a fool or a traitor or an enemy of our soldiers is a person that has taken a stand against the best in our tradition.

Yes, we must stand, and we must speak. [tape skip]...have moved to break the betrayal of my own silences and to speak from the burnings of my own heart, as I have called for radical departures from the destruction of Vietnam. Many persons have questioned me about the wisdom of my path. At the heart of their concerns, this query has often loomed large and loud: "Why are you speaking about the war, Dr. King? Why are you joining the voices of dissent?" Peace and civil rights don't mix,

they say. And so this morning, I speak to you on this issue, because I am determined to take the Gospel seriously. And I come this morning to my pulpit to make a passionate plea to my beloved nation.

This sermon is not addressed to Hanoi, or to the National Liberation Front. It is not addressed to China or to Russia. Nor is it an attempt to overlook the ambiguity of the total situation and the need for a collective solution to the tragedy of Vietnam. Nor is it an attempt to make North Vietnam or the National Liberation Front paragons of virtue, nor to overlook the role they must play in a successful resolution of the problem. This morning, however, I wish not to speak with Hanoi and the National Liberation Front, but rather to my fellow Americans, who bear the greatest responsibility, and entered a conflict that has exacted a heavy price on both continents.

Now, since I am a preacher by calling, I suppose it is not surprising that I have seven major reasons for bringing Vietnam into the field of my moral vision. There is...a very obvious and almost facile connection between the war in Vietnam and the struggle I and others have been waging in America. A few years ago there was a shining moment in that struggle. It seemed that there was a real promise of hope for the poor, both black and white, through the Poverty Program. There were experiments, hopes, and new beginnings. Then came the build-up in Vietnam. And I watched the program broken as if it was some idle political plaything of a society gone mad on war. And I knew that America would never invest the necessary funds or energies in rehabilitation of its poor so long as adventures like Vietnam continued to draw men and skills and money, like some demonic, destructive suction tube. And you may not know it, my friends, but it is estimated that we spend \$500,000 to kill each enemy soldier, while we spend only fifty-three dollars for each person classified as poor, and much of that fifty-three dollars goes for salaries to people that are not poor. So I was increasingly compelled to see the war as an enemy of the poor, and attack it as such.

Perhaps the more tragic recognition of reality took place when it became clear to me that the war was doing far more than devastating the hope of the poor at home. It was sending their sons, and their brothers, and their husbands to fight and die in extraordinarily high proportion relative to the rest of the population. We were taking the black young men who had been crippled by society and sending them eight thousand miles away to guarantee liberties in Southeast Asia which they had not found in Southwest Georgia and East Harlem. So we have been repeatedly faced with a cruel irony of watching Negro and white boys on TV screens as they kill and die together for a nation that has been unable to seat them together in the same school room. So we watch them in brutal solidarity, burning the huts of a poor village. But we realize that they would hardly live on the same

block in Chicago or Atlanta. Now, I could not be silent in the face of such cruel manipulation of the poor.

My third reason moves to an even deeper level of awareness, for it grows out of my experience in the ghettos of the North over the last three years--especially the last three summers. As I have walked among the desperate, rejected, and angry young men, I have told them that Molotov cocktails and rifles would not solve their problems. I have tried to offer them my deepest compassion while maintaining my conviction that social change comes most meaningfully through non-violent action; for they ask and write me, "So what about Vietnam?" They ask if our nation wasn't using massive doses of violence to solve its problems to bring about the changes it wanted. Their questions hit home, and I knew that I could never again raise my voice against the violence of the oppressed in the ghettos without first having spoken clearly to the greatest purveyor of violence in the world today: my own government. For the sake of those boys, for the sake of this government, for the sake of the hundreds of thousands trembling under our violence I cannot be silent. Been a lot of applauding over the last few years. They applauded our total movement; they've applauded me. America and most of its newspapers applauded me in Montgomery. And I stood before thousands of Negroes getting ready to riot when my home was bombed and said, we can't do it this way. They applauded us in the sit-in movement--we non-violently decided to sit in at lunch counters. They applauded us on the Freedom Rides when we accepted blows without retaliation. They praised us in Albany and Birmingham and Selma, Alabama. Oh, the press was so noble in its applause, and so noble in its praise when I was saying, Be non-violent toward Bull Connor; when I was saying, Be non-violent toward [Selma, Alabama segregationist sheriff] Jim Clark. There's something strangely inconsistent about a nation and a press that will praise you when you say, Be non-violent toward Jim Clark, but will curse and damn you when you say, "Be non-violent toward little brown Vietnamese children. There's something wrong with that press!

As if the weight of such a commitment to the life and health of America were not enough, another burden of responsibility was placed upon me in 1964. And I cannot forget that the Nobel Peace Prize was not just something taking place, but it was a commission--a commission to work harder than I had ever worked before for the brotherhood of Man. This is a calling that takes me beyond national allegiances. But even if it were not present, I would yet have to live with the meaning of my commitment to the ministry of Jesus Christ. To me, the relationship of this ministry to the making of peace is so obvious that I sometimes marvel at those who ask me why I am speaking against the war. Could it be that they do not know that the Good News was meant for all men, for communists and capitalists, for their children and ours, for black and white, for revolutionary and conservative. Have they forgotten that my ministry is in obedience to the One who loved His enemies so

fully that he died for them? What, then, can I say to the Vietcong, or to Castro, or to Mao, as a faithful minister to Jesus Christ? Can I threaten them with death, or must I not share with them my life? Finally, I must be true to my conviction that I share with all men the calling to be the son of the Living God. Beyond the calling of race or nation or creed is this vocation of sonship and brotherhood. And because I believe that the Father is deeply concerned, especially for His suffering and helpless and outcast children, I come today to speak for them. And as I ponder the madness of Vietnam and search within myself for ways to understand and respond in compassion, my mind goes constantly to the people of that peninsula. I speak not now of the soldiers of each side, not of the military government of Saigon, but simply of the people who have been under the curse of war for almost three continuous decades now. I think of them, too, because it is clear to me that there will be no meaningful solution until some attempt is made to know these people and hear their broken cries.

Now, let me tell you the truth about it. They must see Americans as strange liberators. Do you realize that the Vietnamese people proclaimed their own independence in 1945 after a combined French and Japanese occupation. And incidentally, this was before the Communist revolution in China. They were led by Ho Chi Minh. And this is a little-known fact, and these people declared themselves independent in 1945. They quoted our Declaration of Independence in their document of freedom, and yet our government refused to recognize them. President Truman said they were not ready for independence. So we fell victim as a nation at that time of the same deadly arrogance that has poisoned the international situation for all of these years. France then set out to reconquer its former colony. And they fought eight long, hard, brutal years trying to re-conquer Vietnam. You know who helped France? It was the United States of America. It came to the point that we were meeting more than eighty percent of the war costs. And even when France started despairing of its reckless action, we did not. And in 1954, a conference was called at Geneva, and an agreement was reached, because France had been defeated at Dien Bien Phu. But even after that, and after the Geneva Accord, we did not stop. We must face the sad fact that our government sought, in a real sense, to sabotage the Geneva Accord. Well, after the French were defeated, it looked as if independence and land reform would come through the Geneva agreement. But instead the United States came and started supporting a man named Diem who turned out to be one of the most ruthless dictators in the history of the world. He set out to silence all opposition. People were brutally murdered because they raised their voices against the brutal policies of Diem. And the peasants watched and cringed as Diem ruthlessly rooted out all opposition. The peasants watched as all this was presided over by United States influence and by increasing numbers of United States troops who came to help quell the insurgency that Diem's methods had

aroused. When Diem was overthrown, they may have been happy, but the long line of military dictatorships seemed to offer no real change, especially in terms of their need for land and peace. And who are we supporting in Vietnam today? It's a man by the name of general Ky [Air Vice Marshal Nguyen Cao Ky] who fought with the French against his own people, and who said on one occasion that the greatest hero of his life is Hitler. This is who we are supporting in Vietnam today. Oh, our government and the press generally won't tell us these things, but God told me to tell you this morning. The truth must be told.

The only change came from America as we increased our troop commitments in support of governments which were singularly corrupt, inept, and without popular support and all the while the people read our leaflets and received regular promises of peace and democracy and land reform. Now they languish under our bombs and consider us, not their fellow Vietnamese, the real enemy. They move sadly and apathetically as we herd them off the land of their fathers into concentration camps, where minimal social needs are rarely met. They know they must move or be destroyed by our bombs. So they go, primarily women, and children and the aged. They watch as we poison their water, as we kill a million acres of their crops. They must weep as the bulldozers roar through their areas preparing to destroy the precious trees. They wander into the towns and see thousands of thousands of the children, homeless, without clothes, running in packs on the streets like animals. They see the children degraded by our soldiers as they beg for food. They see the children selling their sisters to our soldiers, soliciting for their mothers. We have destroyed their two most cherished institutions: the family and the village. We have destroyed their land and their crops. We have cooperated in the crushing of the nation's only noncommunist revolutionary political force, the United Buddhist Church. This is a role our nation has taken, the role of those who make peaceful revolutions impossible but refusing to give up the privileges and the pleasures that comes from the immense profits of overseas investments. I'm convinced that if we are to get on the right side of the world revolution, we as a nation must undergo a radical revolution of values. We must rapidly begin the shift from a thing-oriented society to a person-oriented society. When machines and computers, profit motives and property rights are considered more important than people, the giant triplets of racism, militarism and economic exploitation are incapable of being conquered.

A true revolution of values will soon cause us to question the fairness and justice of many of our present policies. On the one hand, we are called to play the Good Samaritan on life's roadside, but that will be only an initial act. One day we must come to see that the whole Jericho Road must be changed so that men and women will not be constantly beaten and robbed as they make their journey on life's highway. True compassion is more than flinging a coin to a beggar. A true revolution of

values will soon look uneasily on the glaring contrast of poverty and wealth with righteous indignation. It will look across the seas and see individual capitalists of the West investing huge sums of money in Asia, Africa, and South America, only to take the profits out with no concern for the social betterment of the countries, and say, "This is not just." It will look at our alliance with the landed gentry of Latin America and say, "This is not just." The Western arrogance of feeling that it has everything to teach others and nothing to learn from them is not just. A true revolution of values will lay hands on the world order and say of war, "This way of settling differences is not just." This business of burning human beings with napalm, of filling our nation's homes with orphans and widows, of injecting poisonous drugs of hate into the veins of peoples normally humane, of sending men home from dark and bloody battlefields physically handicapped and psychologically deranged, cannot be reconciled with wisdom, justice, and love. A nation that continues year after year to spend more money on military defense than on programs of social uplift is approaching spiritual death.

Oh, my friends, if there is any one thing that we must see today is that these are revolutionary times. All over the globe men are revolting against old systems of exploitation and oppression, and out of the wounds of a frail world, new systems of justice and equality are being born. The shirtless and barefoot people of the land are rising up as never before. The people who sat in darkness have seen a great light. They are saying, unconsciously, as we say in one of our freedom songs, "Ain't gonna let nobody turn me around!" It is a sad fact that because of comfort, complacency, a morbid fear of communism, our proneness to adjust to injustice, the Western nations that initiated so much of the revolutionary spirit of the modern world have now become the arch anti-revolutionaries. This has driven many to feel that only Marxism has a revolutionary spirit. Therefore, communism is a judgment against our failure to make democracy real and follow through on the revolutions that we initiated. Our only hope today lies in our ability to recapture the revolutionary spirit and go out into a sometimes hostile world declaring eternal hostility to poverty, racism, and militarism. With this powerful commitment we shall boldly challenge the status quo, we shall boldly challenge unjust mores, and thereby speed up the day when "every valley shall be exalted, and every mountain and hill shall be made low, and the rough places shall be made plain, and the crooked places straight. And the glory of the Lord shall be revealed, and all flesh shall see it together."

A genuine revolution of values means in the final analysis that our loyalties must become ecumenical rather than sectional. Every nation must now develop an overriding loyalty to mankind as a whole in order to preserve the best in their individual societies. This call for a worldwide fellowship that lifts neighborly concern beyond one's tribe, race, class, and

nation is in reality a call for an all-embracing, unconditional love for all men. This oft misunderstood and misinterpreted concept, so readily dismissed by the Nietzsches of the world as a weak and cowardly force, has now become an absolute necessity for the survival of mankind. And when I speak of love I'm not speaking of some sentimental and weak response. I am speaking of that force which all of the great religions have seen as the supreme unifying principle of life. Love is somehow the key that unlocks the door which leads to ultimate reality. This Hindu-Muslim-Christian-Jewish-Buddhist belief about ultimate reality is beautifully summed up in the first epistle of John: "Let us love one another, for God is love. And every one that loveth is born of God and knoweth God. He that loveth not knoweth not God, for God is love. If we love one another, God dwelleth in us and his love is perfected in us."

Let me say finally that I oppose the war in Vietnam because I love America. I speak out against this war, not in anger, but with anxiety and sorrow in my heart, and, above all, with a passionate desire to see our beloved country stand as the moral example of the world. I speak out against this war because I am disappointed with America. And there can be no great disappointment where there is not great love. I am disappointed with our failure to deal positively and forthrightly with the triple evils of racism, economic exploitation, and militarism. We are presently moving down a dead-end road that can lead to national disaster. America has strayed to the far country of racism and militarism. The home that all too many Americans left was solidly structured idealistically; its pillars were solidly grounded in the insights of our Judeo-Christian heritage. All men are made in the image of God. All men are brothers. All men are created equal. Every man is an heir to a legacy of dignity and worth. Every man has rights that are neither conferred by, nor derived from the State--they are God-given. Out of one blood, God made all men to dwell upon the face of the earth. What a marvelous foundation for any home! What a glorious and healthy place to inhabit. But America's strayed away, and this unnatural excursion has brought only confusion and bewilderment. It has left hearts aching with guilt and minds distorted with irrationality.

It is time for all people of conscience to call upon America to come back home. Come home, America. Omar Khayyam is right: "The moving finger writes, and having writ moves on." I call on Washington today. I call on every man and woman of good will all over America today. I call on the young men of America who must make a choice today to take a stand on this issue. Tomorrow may be too late. The book may close. And don't let anybody make you think that God chose America as his divine, messianic force to be a sort of policeman of the whole world. God has a way of standing before the nations with judgment, and it seems that I can hear God saying to America, "You're too arrogant! And if you don't change your ways, I will rise up and break the backbone of your power, and I'll place it in

the hands of a nation that doesn't even know my name. Be still and know that I'm God."

Now it isn't easy to stand up for truth and for justice. Sometimes it means being frustrated. When you tell the truth and take a stand, sometimes it means that you will walk the streets with a burdened heart. Sometimes it means losing a job...means being abused and scorned. It may mean having a seven, eight year old child asking a daddy, "Why do you have to go to jail so much?" And I've long since learned that to be a follower to the Jesus Christ means taking up the cross. And my bible tells me that Good Friday comes before Easter. Before the crown we wear, there is the cross that we must bear. Let us bear it--bear it for truth, bear it for justice, and bear it for peace. Let us go out this morning with that determination. And I have not lost faith. I'm not in despair, because I know that there is a moral order. I haven't lost faith, because the arc of the moral universe is long, but it bends toward justice. I can still sing "We Shall Overcome" because Carlyle was right: "No lie can live forever." We shall overcome because William Cullen Bryant was right: "Truth pressed to earth will rise again." We shall overcome because James Russell Lowell was right: "Truth forever on the scaffold, wrong forever on the throne." Yet, that scaffold sways the future. We shall overcome because the bible is right: "You shall reap what you sow." With this faith we will be able to hew out of the mountain of despair a stone of hope. With this faith we

will be able to transform the jangling discords of our world into a beautiful symphony of brotherhood. With this faith we will be able to speed up the day when justice will roll down like waters, and righteousness like a mighty stream. With this faith we will be able to speed up the day when the lion and the lamb will lie down together, and every man will sit under his own vine and fig tree, and none shall be afraid because the words of the Lord have spoken it. With this faith we will be able to speed up the day when all over the world we will be able to join hands and sing in the words of the old Negro spiritual, "Free at last! Free at last! Thank God Almighty, we're free at last!" With this faith, we'll sing it as we're getting ready to sing it now. Men will beat their swords into plowshares and their spears into pruning hooks. And nations will not rise up against nations, neither shall they study war anymore. And I don't know about you, I ain't gonna study war no more.

Transcript by Gary Handman, UC Berkeley Media Resources Center, 2006

[Riverside Speech Transcript - The Pacifica Radio/UC Berkeley Social Activism Recording Project - Library Guides at UC Berkeley](#)

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2.2: Writing for an Audience Classroom Activity

We will start with an instructor-guided class collaboration. As a class, identify all the audience signifiers on a board (or similar area of focus). You may need to include some context for people who did not grow up in a church or know biblical language such as the Bible verses quoted and referenced. Make sure everyone has the opportunity to contribute.

Open-ended questions for the class:

- Why did he choose to incorporate these signifiers to his audience?
- Would it have made a difference to them if he didn't?
- What are some drawbacks to having a speech or essay targeted to a limited audience?

- Why not just write or speak to everyone?
- What are some benefits of knowing and writing to a designated audience?
- What if he addressed this speech to someone else, say the VietCong (Vietnamese Resistance Fighters), while speaking in this church; how might that have changed the effectiveness of his speech?
- If you were delivering a speech or writing an essay like this to your peers, what kinds of signifiers might you use to draw them in?

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2.3: Writing for an Audience Assignment

Assignment: Imagine that you are writing an essay or delivering a speech to a group of your peers. What would that look and sound like? Who are your peers? What are some of their defining characteristics?

In a small group or individually, plan on writing a two-page anti-war speech about a current war or social crisis, to an audience of your peers, that you could deliver to an audience of your peers.

What does that look like? How do you address the audience? What concerns might be at the forefront of this war/conflict/crisis? How does or could this conflict affect you and your peers (As Tupac put it "They got money for wars/but can't feed the poor")? How can you address that in your speech? Does your audience have any role in this conflict? Could, for example, their college or school have stocks in a weapons manufacturer or is it invested in one of the sides? Could your audience play a role in affecting the war? What kinds of actions could they take?

What kinds of signifiers would you use to identify your audience? What can they do? Would it make sense to put some or all of the responsibility for the conflict/crisis on your peers? Can they do something about it? How will your speech or essay address that?

Now that you have a framework, draft the essay or speech. Is there somewhere you can deliver this essay or speech? As a long-form or a series of videos, on a stream, in your quad, during an anti-war protest? Think of this beyond your classroom.

Reference:

Shakur, Tupac. "Keep Your Head Up." *Strictly 4 My N.I.*.A.Z...* Interscope Records, 1994.

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

3: Decolonization and Listening to the Research

Students will listen to and reflect on a podcast on decolonization and learning from a living ancestor. You will then have three options to practice lessons learned.

[3.1: Decolonization and Research Introduction and Text](#)

[3.2: Decolonization and Research Activity](#)

[3.3: Decolonization and Research Assignment](#)

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3.1: Decolonization and Research Introduction and Text

Introduction:

Think of a time when you were anticipating one thing and worked hard to get it. Instead, you got something else. Perhaps at the time you did not even recognize what you received. You may have been disappointed, even angry. But then was there a moment you realized that the other gift, item, event, or time you received instead had benefits that you otherwise would never have considered? Maybe you found something important that you otherwise would have gone without. Maybe what you got was a toy or a relationship that you lost or that never started; perhaps it was a job; maybe a trip.

Research can be like that too. We can sometimes spend a designated amount of time trying to get the answers we are expecting, only to end up without what we were looking for. But maybe we have more insight than we were initially looking for. Maybe we got a gift instead.

In the following audio story, Native American scholar Charlie Amáyá Scott (of the Diné people) had expected to learn about her Indigenous history from her grandmother's perspective but felt daunted at first by how long the process was taking. The fact that her grandmother did not understand the academic words Charlie was using to describe her connection to the land seemed to disturb her initially as well.

While you are listening, try to define the term “decolonization” without looking it up, only using the cues from the podcast. Additionally, identify what the grandmother gives the narrator.

Audio text: Listen to Charlie Amáyá Scott's episode in *The Pedagogy Lab* from April 1, 2021, “A Decolonial Memoir: Frustrations and Desires.”

<https://soundcloud.com/thepedagogylib/a-decolonial-memoir-desires-and-frustrations>

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3.2: Decolonization and Research Activity

In groups, discuss how you would define decolonization based on this listening.

Decolonization is a useful word for a process, but like all other words, it can mean nothing to those who hear it and don't have a context for it. Most people have never heard of the term, let alone have a definition for it. Surely a grandmother in a rural area who does not have running water would not have a definition ready for this term, but her experiences and knowledge can deepen an understanding of it.

For reference, colonization has been ongoing in much of the world in a variety of ways since at least 1492. European-based societies have been working to eradicate, hide, exploit, and steal the people, language, and cultures of the Indigenous throughout the world. This is most evident in what are known as settler colonies such as the United States, Canada, Australia, and Palestine, and in former settler colonies such as "Rhodesia" and Apartheid South Africa. In these countries, the colonists took the land directly from the native people and directly ruled and controlled the government and resources. Boarding schools along with reservations were a couple of methods chosen in the United States to erase or hide Indigenous people and their cultures. Native children were forced to leave their homes to go to far-away boarding schools with children from other tribes and nations. There, the children were cut off from their parents, families, and cultural practices. Speaking their native tongue was outlawed and any infractions were severely punished, often leading to mass graves found on these former sites. Here we hear that the grandmother lost many of her friends as a child in these boarding schools.

Decolonization is the effort to remove the effects of colonization. It is the process through which the Indigenous regain their power, their land, their use of language and culture, and their resources.

Do you think Charlie's grandmother knew something of decolonization even if she didn't know the language for it?

As a class, discuss what Charlie Amáyá Scott expected to get from her grandmother. Does it differ from what she eventually got?

When Ms. Scott went to spend time with her grandmother to continue her research on decolonization, she was initially disappointed. Yet, after carefully listening and prodding, her grandmother opened up about her past, about myths and other stories from their people. The insight she found was invaluable, but she needed to spend time working with her grandmother to hear these Diné stories.

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3.3: Decolonization and Research Assignment

Choose one or three of the following alternative assignments:

1)

Now would be a good time to investigate the Indigenous people of the land. Find out the name of one or two tribes, nations, or people groups who originally lived in your region. Is there a reservation or officially recognized tribe near you? Compile research on one of the tribes. Look for their mentions in old newspapers, historical sites, and at your local libraries and museums. Find their official (and unofficial) websites and memoirs, biographies, and autobiographies from tribe members. Does your city, town, or county recognize this tribe on their websites and tourist pamphlets?

Answer these questions:

- What is the name of the tribe you selected?
- Do they belong to a greater nation or confederacy?
- Where had they originally lived and where were they resettled (if they were)?
- What is their history of contact with the federal government?
- Do they have treaties and what do those treaties recognize?
- What trades and practices did they specialize in?
- Can you find origin myths or other meaningful stories?
- What form of governance did they practice and is that similar to what they have now?
- What other things can you learn about this tribe?

2)

Normally when we are new to researching a topic, we might spend a few minutes here or there looking at some websites. An online encyclopedia or a pros-and-cons website or book and maybe a few scattered sources may seem enough for beginning research, and maybe that is all you have researched with previously. However, challenge yourself to spend a whole afternoon in a library; whether a local one, one at your school, or in a nearby university you have access to.

For your current research project or essay, take out a few books on your subject. Look for your topic in both the Table of Contents in the front and Index in the back and read the relevant pages, plus a few surrounding pages for more context. Find four relevant journal articles on your topic to read and take notes about. Then look at the bibliographies from the journals and books for more relevant or interesting articles and books on or related to your subject.

Keep index cards to record this bevy of information and where you have found it.

Let this research inform how you will construct your essay rather than relying on preconceived notions of a simple five-paragraph essay.

3)

Challenge yourself to listen intently to your research. Research something that is of value to you: a question, an identity, a family history. The best research is time spent meandering. Read the bibliographies of studies you've found to find other related (and interesting) studies and books. Find out how the research is conducted. Read memoirs and dig deep into mentioned events that you also find interesting.

In other words, take the research where you don't expect it to take you. Learn from it and let it challenge you.

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

4: What is Critical Race Theory- Definitional Writing

Students will recognize the importance of defining topics and key terminology through the example of the somehow controversial term "Critical Race Theory." Students will engage with prior and mass conceptions of the term, read and evaluate scholarly, contextualized, and historical uses of the term, and generate their own standardized definitions. Students will then look at non-classic definition models and generate those as well.

[4.1: Definitional Writing Introduction and Texts](#)

[4.2: Definitional Writing Activity](#)

[4.3: Definitional Writing Assignment](#)

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4.1: Definitional Writing Introduction and Texts

One of the hallmarks of good writing is having clear definitions of used terminology. After all, what does it mean when a writer drones on and on about a particular subject, but the reader has no idea what the writer is talking about or perhaps has a different idea altogether? Take for example the term Critical Race Theory (or CRT). For the last few years, the term has been bandied about on mainstream media, in state halls of power, and within social media circles as a dreaded but vague concept. Those who have only heard of this concept through watching *CNN* or *Fox News* or through emails from rightwing politicians could be forgiven for thinking that CRT is some radical revision of history invented to divide people based on the color of their skin, to make white children feel guilty for crimes they personally never participated in, or to make Black people perpetual victims. On the other hand, those who read between the lines may see CRT instead as any teaching curriculum that tells the truth about racist history and laws in the United States. While closer to the truth, the fact is that Critical Race Theory (like Intersectionalism) is a legal framework first and foremost and created for better legal representation. The way the term is used is as a boogey-man placeholder. Because few understand what the term means, fear factories can place whatever value they want on it so that they do not have to come right out and say what they mean: that acknowledging history makes them look bad.

To truly understand such a charged and obscured term, we should look at the experts. As you read the following excerpts from scholars and educators, pay attention to how they define the term:

From Daniel D. Liou and Raquel Alvara:

In reality, CRT is a theoretical framework, methodology, and praxis used to challenge assumptions associated with race neutrality by illuminating systemic racism and other intersectional forms of oppression in education, law, and society (Dixon et al., 2017; Ladson-Billings & Tate, 1995; Ledesma & Calderón, 2015; Solózano & Yosso, 2002). However, recently CRT has been conflated as a catchall phrase to weaponize against school-based curriculum focused on fostering justice, equity, diversity, and inclusion (López et al., 2021). In the fall of 2021 in Texas, books related to diversity were banned and some teachers were instructed to teach opposing views to issues such as the Holocaust and slavery to avoid offending families in favor of those views (Hixenbaugh & Hylton, 2021). These dynamics alleged teachers were implementing critical race theory to indoctrinate students, despite evidence showing the majority of U.S. schools are not teaching such curriculum (McCausland, 2021).

From Vera Kennedy and Rowena Bermio:

Critical Race Theory (CRT) is a socio-intellectual movement of civil rights scholars and activists who challenge approaches to racial justice in U.S. laws. A key concept of CRT is intersectionality and how forms of inequality and identity are affected by race, class, gender, and disability. CRT emphasizes critical thinking about race, views race as a social construct, uses storytelling to explore lived experiences, and argues the idea of race advances the interests of Whites at the expense of people of color. CRT challenges the idea that U.S. law is neutral and color-blind. The movement began in the 1960s, but in 2020 became the focus of U.S. conservative lawmakers to ban and restrict the instruction of CRT and anti-racism education in primary and secondary schools in response to White grievance, guilt, and shame. Those opposed to CRT have misrepresented its principles and significance. CRT has not been part of the U.S. primary and secondary school curriculum. Its study and writings have historically been examined in higher education. Banning or restricting the work of CRT silences discussions about the history of race, racism, equality, and social justice.

And from Gary Minda:

As the 1980s came to a close, a new movement in legal thought emerged offering a new epistemological source for law derived from the "actual experience, history, culture, and intellectual tradition of people of color." This movement developed as racial-minority scholars within critical legal studies and other progressive networks established "an African American movement" in legal studies to approach problems of race from the unique perspective of African Americans. Critical race theorists asserted that it was time for "different and blacker voices [to] speak new words and remake old legal doctrines." The critical race theory movement emerged as minority scholars developed a race consciousness form of legal criticism. "Race consciousness " characterizes the jurisprudential perspective of minority scholars who emphasize the need for fundamental changes in the way the law constructs knowledge about race. Critical race theorists focus on racial consciousness to address the question of "color " in American law. The traditional view of the law of race discrimination has been structured by a silent category that distinguishes between people of different color. The color "white " has, for example, served as an implicit legal benchmark for determining whether the goal of legal equality has been achieved—equality requires that people of color enjoy the same formal rights and process as the dominant group. Critical race theorists argue that this way of thinking has the ideological consequence of convincing minorities that racial

discrimination can only be eradicated through the implementation of color-blind meritocratic standards, which accord whites and blacks the same formal rights and process. Critical race theorists claim that when color is used in this way, it can reinforce racist attitudes prevailing in society that seek to justify the oppression of racial minorities. They contend that by generalizing the category of race, the law reinforces the stereotypes of minority groups that have historically subordinated all people of color. It is said that the law's generalization of the category of race suppresses knowledge about the different cultural experiences and attitudes of racial groups. Race consciousness is thus the critical method these scholars advance in their struggle to achieve racial equality in the law. Color of skin pigmentation is viewed by critical race scholars as a symbol of cultural and personal identity constructed by white society.

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4.2: Definitional Writing Activity

How do these texts differ from how we have heard CRT discussed before?

When we speak of definitions, usually we think of a dictionary, which we can also refer to as the classical definition. This comprises of identifying both the kind of class the topic belongs to and how it differentiates from others in its class.

For instance, ice cream is a frozen dessert, right? That is the class in which it belongs. But how does it differ from, say, ice pops, slushies, bananas Foster, snow cones, Italian ice, or sorbet? We understand it's different because of its creamy texture that usually comes from its (usual) main ingredients of milk and cream and its process of stirring while freezing; that it is heavily sweetened and flavored with a spice such as vanilla, chocolate, and mint; and usually includes additional ingredients such as strawberries, peaches, cookie dough, fudge bits, lemon, chocolate chips, mango, or even bubblegum or peppers.

To go more general, desserts are a type of food, but they differ from others in that they have no nutritional value, are sweet, and often come after a dinner course.

The classic definition of dessert may look like this: "A sweet food item consumed for recreation that lacks nutritional value."

House cats are a type of animal. More specifically, they are mammals that belong to the family Felidae along with lions, leopards, lynxes, tigers, and panthers. How are they distinct from other types of cats, then?

Humans are primates; how are we different from other apes?

An example of a classic definition may look like:

Humans (*homo sapiens*) are a species of primate that *walk upright, have a complex relationship with language, thought, and symbology, and possess an innate grasp of tool making and use.*

Can we compile what we have just read about Critical Race Theory into a working, classical definition?

Class: _____;

Differentiation from others in its class:

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4.3: Definitional Writing Assignment

The formal dictionary method is not the only way to define terminology for our readers. We can define terms like CRT using different models including examples, comparisons and contrasts, origin and development, process, characteristics, synonyms, and negation. Not all of these methods will work for each term, nor will they all have the same strength for each term, but they can help create a fuller picture for our audiences. After each method and example given below, create an example using what you know of CRT and of one other topic that you think is misunderstood in the public sphere (such as Global Warming, racism, feminism, trans rights, Islamophobia, and homophobia).

- Examples
 - Waterfowl: Penguins, ducks, geese, seagulls
 - Respiratory system: nasal cavity, trachea, larynx, airways, lungs, blood vessels
 - CRT: _____
 - Other topic: _____
- Compare and contrast
 - cats and dogs are domesticated, have fur, walk on fours, and have numerous children at the same time
 - cats are predatory while dogs are defensive
 - cats and dogs are intensely loyal, but they show them in different ways
 - dogs have stronger sense of smell and hearing
 - CRT: _____
 - Other topic: _____
- Process
 - Ice cream: take milk/cream and sugar and mix into a tub filled with salt and ice; begin slow churning. Then, add flavors to the cream and sugar mixture as it continues to churn...
 - CRT: _____
 - Other topic: _____
- Synonyms
 - Hard-working: arduous, on-task, sweating, back-breaking, timely...
 - Syrupy: sticky, sweet, slow-moving, viscous
 - CRT: _____
 - Other topic: _____
- By negation
 - Love is not mean, abusive, nor hurtful.
 - A horse isn't a dog, a car, nor a fish.
 - CRT: _____
 - Other topic: _____
- Listing characteristics
 - Spies lie, sneak, and are distrustful.
 - A bus seats many people, is big, and has lots of room for maneuverability.
 - CRT: _____
 - Other topic: _____
- Origin and development
 - Railroads developed elsewhere but came into fruition in the United States as the country expanded from the Atlantic to the Pacific Oceans, as heavily-exploited laborers came from China, as corporations and trusts were rising and swallowing smaller companies, and as the government was seeking to drive Indigenous people into increasingly smaller reservations.
 - World War I began as European nations struggled with each other over the absence of lands and people to conquer and colonize. Along with this came the advent of much more dangerous and lethal weapons (such as dynamite), and ways to deliver those weapons (airplanes), and the shifting of alliances.
 - CRT: _____
 - Other topic: _____

Now you can use one or more of these methods to define unclear terms in your essays.

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

5: Climate Change Responsibility - A Paraphrasing Exercise

Learning Objectives

- 7: Integrate students' own ideas with those of others
- 9: Summarize, analyze, and evaluate the arguments, counterarguments, and evidence in the writing of others

Students will practice paraphrasing text using an open letter call to emergency action from health professionals on global climate change and health. Students will then integrate the work of others into an argumentative essay or response letter.

[5.1: Climate Change and Paraphrasing Readings](#)

[5.2: Climate Change and Paraphrasing Classroom Activity](#)

[5.3: Climate Change and Paraphrasing Activities](#)

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5.1: Climate Change and Paraphrasing Readings

Introduction to text:

At the end of this learning object, students should be able to paraphrase and integrate the ideas of others along with their own into a short, formal essay about the responsibility of global climate change.

Please read the call-to-action letter carefully, taking notes on vocabulary, tone, repeated themes, and context.

Pre-reading:

Global climate change is an ongoing and worsening threat to the planet, to life, and certainly to health. It also disproportionately affects the Global South (or developing nations) which have had the least responsibility in amassing and yet suffer polluting and destroying the ecosystem and yet suffer the most damage from the pollution and destruction. Meanwhile, the world's richest countries and their multinational corporations continue to expand their polluting and environment-destroying ways. The promises these world leaders make tend to be little more than symbolic gestures, and what little promises they make, they tend to ignore or move further down the line.

Here, a group of health science editors call for more responsibility from these wealthy countries and their leaders.

Reading Material

Call for Emergency Action to Limit Global Temperature Increases, Restore Biodiversity, and Protect Health. Wealthy Nations Must Do Much More, Much Faster.

The UN General Assembly in September 2021 will bring countries together at a critical time for marshalling collective action to tackle the global environmental crisis. They will meet again at the biodiversity summit in Kunming, China, and the climate conference (COP26) in Glasgow, UK. Ahead of these pivotal meetings, we -- the editors of health journals worldwide -- call for urgent action to keep average global temperature increases below 1.5°C, halt the destruction of nature, and protect health.

Health is already being harmed by global temperature increases and the destruction of the natural world, a state of affairs health professionals have been bringing attention to for decades. The science is unequivocal; a global increase of 1.5°C above the pre-industrial average and the continued loss of biodiversity risk catastrophic harm to health that will be impossible to reverse. Despite the world's necessary preoccupation with Covid-19, we cannot wait for the pandemic to pass to rapidly reduce emissions.

Reflecting the severity of the moment, this editorial appears in health journals across the world. We are united in recognizing that only fundamental and equitable changes to societies will reverse our current trajectory. The risks to health of increases above 1.5°C are now well established. Indeed, no temperature rise is "safe." In the past 20 years, heat-related mortality among people aged over 65 has increased by more than 50%. Higher temperatures have brought increased dehydration and renal function loss, dermatological malignancies, tropical infections, adverse mental health outcomes, pregnancy complications, allergies, and cardiovascular and pulmonary morbidity and mortality. Harms disproportionately affect the most vulnerable, including children, older populations, ethnic minorities, poorer communities, and those with underlying health problems.

Global heating is also contributing to the decline in global yield potential for major crops, falling by 1.8-5.6% since 1981; this, together with the effects of extreme weather and soil depletion, is hampering efforts to reduce undernutrition. Thriving ecosystems are essential to human health, and the widespread destruction of nature, including habitats and species, is eroding water and food security and increasing the chance of pandemics.

The consequences of the environmental crisis fall disproportionately on those countries and communities that have contributed least to the problem and are least able to mitigate the harms. Yet no country, no matter how wealthy, can shield itself from these impacts. Allowing the consequences to fall disproportionately on the most vulnerable will breed more conflict, food insecurity, forced displacement, and zoonotic disease-with severe implications for all countries and communities. As with the Covid-19 pandemic, we are globally as strong as our weakest member.

Rises above 1.5°C increase the chance of reaching tipping points in natural systems that could lock the world into an acutely unstable state. This would critically impair our ability to mitigate harms and to prevent catastrophic, runaway environmental change.

Global targets are not enough

Encouragingly, many governments, financial institutions, and businesses are setting targets to reach net-zero emissions, including targets for 2030. The cost of renewable energy is dropping rapidly. Many countries are aiming to protect at least 30% of the world's land and oceans by 2030.

These promises are not enough. Targets are easy to set and hard to achieve. They are yet to be matched with credible short- and longer-term plans to accelerate cleaner technologies and transform societies. Emissions reduction plans do not adequately incorporate health considerations. Concern is growing that temperature rises above 1.5°C are beginning to be seen as inevitable, or even acceptable, to powerful members of the global community. Relatedly, current strategies for reducing emissions to net zero by the middle of the century implausibly assume that the world will acquire great capabilities to remove greenhouse gases from the atmosphere.

This insufficient action means that temperature increases are likely to be well in excess of 2°C, a catastrophic outcome for health and environmental stability. Crucially, the destruction of nature does not have parity of esteem with the climate element of the crisis, and every single global target to restore biodiversity loss by 2020 was missed. This is an overall environmental crisis.

Health professionals are united with environmental scientists, businesses, and many others in rejecting that this outcome is inevitable. More can and must be done now--in Glasgow and Kunming--and in the immediate years that follow. We join health professionals worldwide who have already supported calls for rapid action.

Equity must be at the center of the global response. Contributing a fair share to the global effort means that reduction commitments must account for the cumulative, historical contribution each country has made to emissions, as well as its current emissions and capacity to respond. Wealthier countries will have to cut emissions more quickly, making reductions by 2030 beyond those currently proposed and reaching net-zero emissions before 2050. Similar targets and emergency action are needed for biodiversity loss and the wider destruction of the natural world.

To achieve these targets, governments must make fundamental changes to how our societies and economies are organized and how we live. The current strategy of encouraging markets to swap dirty for cleaner technologies is not enough. Governments must intervene to support the redesign of transport systems, cities, production and distribution of food, markets for financial investments, health systems, and much more. Global coordination is needed to ensure that the rush for cleaner technologies does not come at the cost of more environmental destruction and human exploitation.

Many governments met the threat of the Covid-19 pandemic with unprecedented funding. The environmental crisis demands a similar emergency response. Huge investment will be needed, beyond what is being considered or delivered anywhere in the world. But such investments will produce huge positive health and economic outcomes. These include high quality jobs, reduced air pollution, increased physical activity, and improved housing and diet.

Better air quality alone would realize health benefits that easily offset the global costs of emissions reductions. These measures will also improve the social and economic determinants of health, the poor state of which may have made populations more vulnerable to the covid-19 pandemic. But the changes cannot be achieved through a return to damaging austerity policies or the continuation of the large inequalities of wealth and power within and between countries.

Cooperation hinges on wealthy nations doing more

In particular, countries that have disproportionately created the environmental crisis must do more to support low- and middle-income countries to build cleaner, healthier, and more resilient societies. High income countries must meet and go beyond their outstanding commitment to provide US\$100 billion a year, making up for any shortfall in 2020 and increasing contributions to and beyond 2025. Funding must be equally split between mitigation and adaptation, including improving the resilience of health systems.

Financing should be through grants rather than loans, building local capabilities and truly empowering communities, and should come alongside forgiving large debts, which constrain the agency of so many low-income countries. Additional funding must be marshalled to compensate for inevitable loss and damage caused by the consequences of the environmental crisis.

As health professionals, we must do all we can to aid the transition to a sustainable, fairer, resilient, and healthier world. Alongside acting to reduce the harm from the environmental crisis, we should proactively contribute to global prevention of further damage and action on the root causes of the crisis. We must hold global leaders to account and continue to educate others about the health risks of the crisis. We must join in the work to achieve environmentally sustainable health systems before 2040, recognizing that this will mean changing clinical practice. Health institutions have already divested more than US\$42 billion of assets from fossil fuels; others should join them. The greatest threat to global public health is the continued failure of world leaders to keep the global

temperature rise below 1.5°C and to restore nature. Urgent, society-wide changes must be made and will lead to a fairer and healthier world. We, as editors of health journals, call for governments and other leaders to act, marking 2021 as the year that the world annually changes course.

Atwoli, L., et. al. (2021). Call for emergency action to limit global temperature increases, restore biodiversity, and protect health. *South African Dental Journal*, 76(9), 511-513. Retrieved July 25, 2024, from http://www.scielo.org.za/scielo.php?script=sci_arttext&pid=S0011-85162021000900001&lng=en&tlng=en.

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5.2: Climate Change and Paraphrasing Classroom Activity

Paraphrasing bad examples:

Sometimes when students are asked to paraphrase and integrate ideas from original texts into their own writing, they are not aware of how to do so properly. They know they must reword phrases, sentences, ideas, or groups of sentences, but without further direction, may be confused how to do so. Take our text from above and its first sentence as an example:

“The UN General Assembly in September 2021 will bring countries together at a critical time for marshalling collective action to tackle the global environmental crisis.”

What if one was told to reword this line and merely went to the thesaurus to find approximate words to replace the others?

“A United Nations Generic Meeting in September of 2021 must take nations combined at a very important hour to line up combined deeds to subdue this worldwide ecological emergency.”

These are all words, surely, but put together they don’t make sense, confuse the reader, and don’t really carry the meaning of the original text. Let’s look at another example, from the second paragraph:

“The science is unequivocal; a global increase of 1.5°C above the pre-industrial average and the continued loss of biodiversity risk catastrophic harm to health that will be impossible to reverse.”

A confused but dutiful thesaurusizing could lead to this result:

“Technology was indisputable; one international uptake of one and a half degrees Celsius over the before-manufacturing means along with the resumed lessening of variety chance fatal hurt to fitness this could be unable to go backwards.”

Again, all words, but meaning is lost and reading it is a chore.

Instead, think of paraphrasing as a translation. We don’t translate from Spanish to English, English to Arabic, Arabic to Chinese using word-for-word variations. Instead, we exchange meaning of ideas-to-ideas rather than word-for-word. Beyond the internal phrase, one must look at context as well. Even simple phrases and words like “love” and “I’m sorry” can mean different things in different contexts. “I’m sorry to inform you that you lost the bid” is different from “I’m sorry to hear about your loss” and certainly distinct from “I’m sorry I did that thing.”

Tips to paraphrase

Consider these following tips for your own paraphrases below. You will likely need to combine several of the steps. In all of them, you should begin by reading to understand. If you don’t understand the text, how can you explain it and simplify it for others? How can you integrate it into your writing? Know what it means in the sentence and in the broader scope.

Imagine you were explaining the text selection to a peer, in words they would understand. Better yet, try explaining it to a peer, like a relative, friend or classmate without looking at it. Then look back at the text to see if you got the gist of it and the major points.

Find the relevant information, pull it out, insert it (giving credit, of course) and make sure it’s translated correctly:

“Scientists say that a three degree rise in temperatures will make living on this planet increasingly worse.”

Reverse the order of the sentence or major ideas:

“It would be impossible to reverse the catastrophic damage done after temperatures rise above 1.5 degrees Celsius from the pre-industrial average and we continue to lose biodiversity.”

While considering the original in its context, use synonyms for some of the words:

“The science is clear...” “... 3 degrees Fahrenheit...”

Turn passive clauses into active and vice versa:

“Catastrophic harm is risked by...”

Change negative statements into positive ones and vice versa:

“... cannot be reversed.”

Combine elements of two sentences:

Global climate change has an adverse effect on human health as health professionals and the scientific community have warned that destroying natural biodiversity and increasing the world's average temperature will cause irreversible catastrophe to human health."

You try:

In groups of two-three, paraphrase one of the following sections based on the text selected for you:

1) "Health is already being harmed by global temperature increases and the destruction of the natural world, a state of affairs health professionals have been bringing attention to for decades. The science is unequivocal; a global increase of 1.5°C above the pre-industrial average and the continued loss of biodiversity risk catastrophic harm to health that will be impossible to reverse."

2) "Many countries are aiming to protect at least 30% of the world's land and oceans by 2030. These promises are not enough. Targets are easy to set and hard to achieve. They are yet to be matched with credible short- and longer-term plans to accelerate cleaner technologies and transform societies. Emissions reduction plans do not adequately incorporate health considerations."

3) "The consequences of the environmental crisis fall disproportionately on those countries and communities that have contributed least to the problem and are least able to mitigate the harms. Yet no country, no matter how wealthy, can shield itself from these impacts."

4) "Financing should be through grants rather than loans, building local capabilities and truly empowering communities, and should come alongside forgiving large debts, which constrain the agency of so many low-income countries. Additional funding must be marshalled to compensate for inevitable loss and damage caused by the consequences of the environmental crisis."

5) "Allowing the consequences to fall disproportionately on the most vulnerable will breed more conflict, food insecurity, forced displacement, and zoonotic disease--with severe implications for all countries and communities."

After ten minutes, converge as a class and share out your results.

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5.3: Climate Change and Paraphrasing Activities

Remember that one of the main purposes of paraphrasing is to integrate someone else's ideas into your own work, taking along what they have to say without interrupting your flow of thought. Consider that you are in conversation with other writers, thinkers, and scientists as well as with your professor, peers, and target audience.

Some tips for integrating others' ideas into your own in your writing:

Name the author or source and give credentials when it helps:

"Dr. Wolfenstein, the head of the biosciences department at _____ proposes [point related to bioscience]."

Not: "Jim Stanley, a writer at Time Magazine, argues [something unrelated to writing]."

Consider the relationship of your take with the source or with the ideas that you are disputing, agreeing with, or struggling with:

"President _____ and Senators _____ and _____ have said they care about the future of the planet, yet their actions show _____, according to [source]."

"Although most people seem to believe _____, Dr. Loren shows a different side of the story. _____."

"While _____ may argue that _____, others such as _____ claim _____."

"This idea is a counterpoint to the prevailing notion of _____ by _____."

"[Example] supports this claim."

Essay writing:

Option one:

Select two or three other articles—at least one being peer-reviewed—relating to the topic of this article, the responsibility of rich countries to halt global climate change. Write a 1,000-1,500 word argumentative essay answering one of these prompts:

What should rich countries such as the United States do about global climate change?

Who has more responsibility to halt global climate change: Individuals or governments? Can we recycle harder and buy enough electric vehicles to get out of this crisis?

Is there credible evidence to back the claim that world leaders see the rise of 1.5 degrees Celsius as "inevitable", as the authors suggest?

Recall that an argumentative essay centers around an assertive but disputable claim. Your job will be to support this claim (thesis) with evidence and logic from your sources. For a prompted essay such as this, the claim is your answer to the prompt.

Cite your sources—whether paraphrased or quoted—using the format (MLA, APA, Turabian) preferred by your professor. No more than 15% of your paper should be directly quoted, so use and integrate paraphrases more often than merely quoting.

Option two:

Using at least one other credible research source, write a 500-word response letter to the authors of this piece, either agreeing or disagreeing with their main points or supporting or critiquing one of the main ideas.

Consider your audience and their reasoning for drafting the letter in your response.

Cite your sources—whether paraphrased or quoted—using the format (MLA, APA, Turabian) preferred by your professor. No more than 15% of your paper should be directly quoted, so use and integrate paraphrases more often than merely quoting.

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